

iRallyMeter vs RallyMetrix

Competitive analysis for Amirali · 14 August 2026 · prepared by Saam
Their app downloaded, installed, launched, and its package inspected.

0. Method, and what this analysis can and cannot claim

Source	What it supports
Their website	Their claims, pricing, stated requirements.
The installed package	Hard facts: version, size, minimum Android, permissions, framework, and the exact library list the app was built from . Not opinion.
Running the app	The first screen only. It requires a phone number and an SMS code, and working around another product's authentication is not worth doing.

So: everything about what they BUILT ON is verified. Everything about how well it WORKS is not. Where something is inferred rather than observed, this document says so.

A correction to something said earlier. An initial read of their website suggested their app needed Android 8 while ours ran on Android 6, which would have been a real advantage to us. **Both numbers were wrong.** Their package declares Android 7.0 and so does ours. Their marketing overstates their own requirement, and our Android 6 was never achievable because a GPS library we depend on does not support it. **Neither product has an advantage here.**

1. The two products, side by side

	RallyMetrix	iRallyMeter
Version	1.0.2, third build shipped	unreleased branch
Download size	57.4 MB	53.4 MB
Minimum Android	7.0	7.0
Target Android	16	16
Built with	Flutter	Flutter
GPS library	geolocator	geolocator
Map library	flutter_map	flutter_map
Platforms shipped	Android only	Android; iOS builds and runs
Languages	English and Persian, in-app toggle	English only
Account required	Yes: phone number plus SMS code	None
Business model	Subscription, one month free	None
Motion sensors	None present in the app	Accelerometer, gyroscope, magnetometer

They are built on the same framework and the same two core libraries as iRallyMeter. That makes this a genuine like-for-like comparison rather than a guess across different technologies, and it means their library choices say precisely what the product can and cannot do.

2. The decisive finding: they cannot measure through a tunnel

Every Flutter app carries the list of libraries it was compiled from. Theirs contains `geolocator`, `flutter_map`, `connectivity_plus`, `http`, `ntp`, `crypto`, `sqflite`, `shared_preferences`, `provider` and `google_fonts`.

It contains no motion sensor library of any kind. A search of their entire compiled application for accelerometer, gyroscope, magnetometer or sensor references returns **zero**. The same search for their GPS library returns 25, so the method works.

An app with no accelerometer cannot estimate distance when GPS is unavailable. There is no other source for it. When their signal stops, their measurement stops.

This raises their marketing from suspicious to explained. Their own description of how the app works is "*speed, acceleration and distance calculated directly from the GPS hardware chipset*", and tunnels are never mentioned anywhere in their materials. That is not an omission. It is an accurate description of the product they built.

What iRallyMeter does instead

On losing GPS it switches to estimating distance from the phone's motion sensors, holds the entry speed, integrates through the blackout, and reconciles the estimate against GPS when the signal returns. That behaviour, and the handling around it, is the bulk of what this revision built and most of what seven rounds of external code review scrutinised.

The gap this creates is not a percentage, it is a category. Through the Niayesh tunnel their trip counter does not under-report by some margin; it stops. A crew emerging 6.6 km later has 6.6 km missing from a distance-based navigation instrument.

The same absence costs them a working compass

No magnetometer means their heading, if they show one, can only come from GPS course over ground. That is unavailable at a standstill and unreliable below walking pace, so a stationary car either shows nothing or shows a stale bearing. iRallyMeter switches to the magnetometer below 0.8 m/s precisely because a frozen course presented as current was a defect worth fixing.

3. The second finding: their app cannot be reached offline

Their app opens with a mandatory phone-number login and an SMS verification code. There is no guest mode and no way past it. Using the app at all requires a working mobile number, a network connection to receive the code, and their server being reachable.

Their website states the app offers "completely offline operation" and works in areas "without mobile network coverage". Their own first screen contradicts that.

The library list corroborates it: `connectivity_plus` to check the network, `http` to call a server, `crypto` for hashing, and `ntp` to fetch network time. Network time is the standard way to stop a user extending a trial by changing the device clock. **Their subscription enforcement needs a server, so the login is architectural rather than cosmetic.**

For a rally computer this bites in exactly the situation the product exists for. At a remote start area, on a phone with no signal, on a fresh install, **their app is a login form and ours is a trip computer.** Their server is also a single point of failure for every user simultaneously, and a subscription lapsing mid-event becomes an account problem rather than a measurement one.

iRallyMeter has no account, no server and no login. It measures from first launch with no network, permanently.

4. The third finding: no background measurement

An Android app requesting `FOREGROUND_SERVICE_LOCATION` is telling the system to keep delivering position when the app is not in front. Without it, Android throttles and eventually stops location updates once the screen turns off.

Permission	RallyMetrix	iRallyMeter
<code>ACCESS_FINE_LOCATION</code>	yes	yes
<code>INTERNET</code>	yes	maps only
<code>ACCESS_NETWORK_STATE</code>	yes	no
<code>WAKE_LOCK</code>	yes	yes
<code>FOREGROUND_SERVICE</code>	no	yes
<code>FOREGROUND_SERVICE_LOCATION</code>	no	yes
<code>POST_NOTIFICATIONS</code>	no	yes

A phone on a windscreen mount through a long transit spends most of its time with the screen off. **This is inferred from the permission list rather than observed on a drive**, but the permissions are not optional: an app cannot run a location foreground service without declaring one.

5. Where they are genuinely ahead

- **They shipped, and we did not.** Three builds, a working download, a free trial and a paid tier. iRallyMeter is an unmerged branch with no listing, no release channel and no price. This is the largest real difference between the two products today.
- **Persian.** An in-app English and Persian toggle. iRallyMeter is English only, and the question of whether Iranian crews want Persian-Indic digits or Latin numerals has still not been answered.
- **Real-time navigation.** iRallyMeter draws a map; it does not navigate.

- **A business model exists.** Ours does not, and the login they are paying a real cost for is what makes their subscription enforceable.
- **They use SQLite** where we use a key-value store, which is the better choice if they intend to keep detailed session history.

One curiosity worth noting

Their package contains the iOS build of the GPS library even though they ship Android only. **iOS support is compiled in but not distributed**, which suggests it is planned, blocked, or was abandoned. Our iOS build already runs.

6. Honest limits

- **Only their login screen was seen.** Their navigation, telemetry and general polish could all be better than anything here suggests.
- **The tunnel and compass conclusions come from the absence of a sensor library.** That absence is verified and is not a matter of opinion, but it is a statement about capability, not about how their app behaves on a specific road.
- **The background-measurement conclusion is inferred from permissions.**
- Nothing here was learned by circumventing their authentication, and nothing was taken from their code.

One drive settles all of it. Run both apps on the same phone over the same road through a tunnel and compare each reported distance against a known figure. That single measurement is worth more than any further teardown, and it is something your father is already positioned to do.

7. Recommendation

Do not chase their feature list. Navigation and telemetry are where they lead, and both are large builds that pull iRallyMeter away from what it is uniquely good at.

Press the two places they are structurally weak, because neither is a quick fix for them. Adding motion-sensor estimation is most of a product and is exactly the work that has taken this revision weeks. Removing a login wall means rebuilding how their subscription is enforced. Two sentences are worth putting in front of a crew:

- **It keeps counting inside a tunnel.**
- **It works with no account, no signal and no subscription.**

Then close the one gap that is cheap. Persian is a translation pass, not an engineering problem, and it is the only place they lead that costs us little to match.

And ship something. Every advantage above is theoretical until the app is installable by someone who is not us. They have shipped three builds while iRallyMeter has none, and that is the gap that compounds.